

# Resume Writing

Litmus V2 career/resume RAG knowledge-base document.

## Resume length

Candidates with fewer than 10 years of experience should generally keep their resume to one page. Senior professionals may use no more than two pages.

## Resume photos

For the US, UK, Canada, and Australia, including a photo on a resume is discouraged because it can trigger unconscious bias and is not standard practice.

## Quantified achievements

Quantified achievements demonstrate measurable impact and let hiring managers gauge the scale and value of contributions quickly. A bullet such as “Reduced deployment time by 40% by automating the CI pipeline” proves impact, while “Responsible for CI pipeline” only states a duty.

## Employment gaps

A functional or combination (hybrid) resume can emphasize skills and accomplishments rather than a strict chronological timeline. Functional resumes group experience by skill category and can help candidates with employment gaps or frequent job changes.

## Action verb tense

Use past-tense action verbs such as Led, Built, and Managed for previous positions, and present-tense verbs such as Lead, Build, and Manage for a current role.

## Internships without full-time experience

Entry-level candidates can place Skills or Projects near the top. Internships can appear in the Experience section like full-time roles, using accomplishment-driven and quantified bullets. Relevant coursework, certifications, and personal projects can strengthen the resume.

## References

Modern resumes should omit a references section. “References available upon request” is unnecessary and outdated; employers can request references separately.

## Summary versus objective

A resume summary highlights existing experience and achievements and suits experienced candidates. A resume objective states career goals and is more suited to students, entry-level applicants, or career changers.